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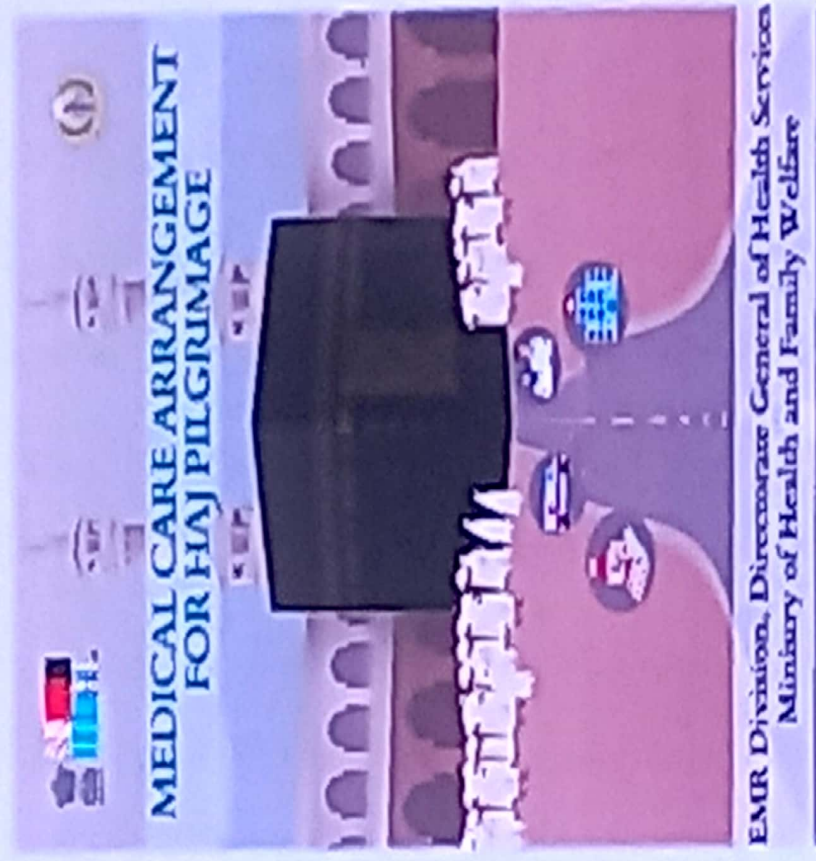
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1. Overview: Role in Medical Care arrangements for Haj

- Ministry of Health & Family Welfare Nodal ministry for:
 - Medical screening & vaccination
 - Deployment of Indian Medical Mission
 - Emergency preparedness
- Works in coordination with:
 - Ministry of Minority Affairs
 - Ministry of External Affairs
 - Haj Committee of India
 - Saudi Ministry of Health
- MoHFW, through its Emergency Medical Relief (EMR) Division of Dte.GHS and others ensure medical preparedness for Indian pilgrims in KSA.

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2. Why Medical Care Matters in Haj?

- Haj pilgrimage is one of the largest global gatherings, around 40 Lakh pilgrims gather for Haj in Kingdom of Saudi Arabia(KSA)
- Annually, 1.75 Lakh Indian Pilgrims visit to KSA for Haj pilgrimage from almost every State/UT.
- Pilgrims may include:
 - Elderly
 - Chronic disease patients
 - First-time international travellers
- Medical preparedness determines:
 - Mortality & morbidity
 - Emergency burden on host country
 - India's international credibility



3. Scale of Haj 2026

1. Total Indian pilgrims: 1.75 lakh
 - Government quota: 1.22 lakh
 - Private quota: 53,000

2. Haj Season 2026: 18th April 2026 to 30th June 2026
 - Core Haj days – 25th May 2026 to 29th May 2026

4. Medical Operations span:

- India
- Transit
- Stay at Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (KSA)
- Core Haj days (Mina–Arafat–Muzdalifah)

4. Where State Haj Inspectors(SHI) fit in?

1. Act as the key **administrative interface** between pilgrims, State authorities, Haj Committee of India and Central Ministries to ensure **compliance, coordination and pilgrim welfare** across all phases of the Haj mission
2. SHIs are the **first administrative interface** for pilgrims to influence-
 - Medical screening quality
 - Compliance with vaccination
 - Identification and protection of vulnerable pilgrims
 - SHIs are **preventive risk preventers**, not observers



5. End-to-End Medical Care Framework



Three stages



I. Pre-departure- Medical care preparedness in India



II. During Haj- Medical Care Services delivery in KSA



III. Emergency response & referral management

5.1 Pre-departure Phase (India)

1. Comprehensive Medical Screening & Fitness Certification 

2. Vaccination of Pilgrims

3. Medical Deputation for Hajj Pilgrimage

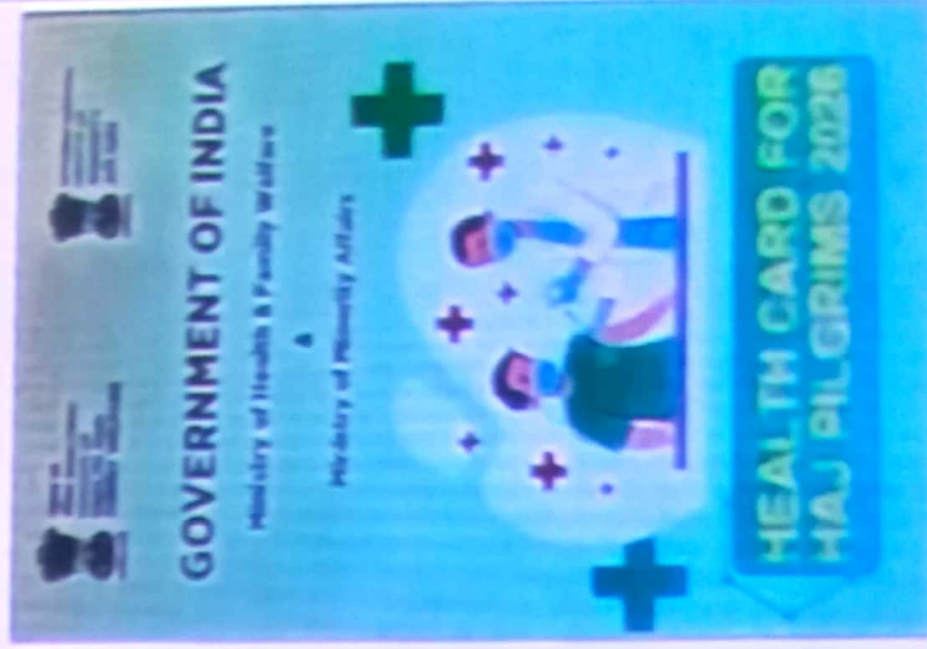
4. Training program for Medical Deputationist

5. Role of State Hajj Inspectors in Health (Pre-departure phase)

Pre-departure Phase (India)

1. Comprehensive Medical Screening & Fitness Certification
 - Medical Screening and Vaccination Mandatory pre-Haj  medical examination.
 - Revised Haj Pilgrims Health Card to ensure only medically fit individuals travel. Six categories considered 'Unfit' -
 1. Active TB & infectious diseases
 2. Active Cancer
 3. Chronic kidney, lung & heart disease
 4. Pregnancy in late trimesters or High risk pregnancy
 5. Serious Psychiatric illness
 6. Advance age with dementia
 - Designed to prevent medical emergencies abroad
 - Health records updation on Haj Pilgrims Health Management Information System (HPHIS) portal

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5.1 Pre-departure Phase (India)

2. Vaccination of Pilgrims (As per Saudi Arabia guidelines)

- 1) QMMV(Meningococcal Meningitis)- All Pilgrims (Mandatory for visa)
- 2) Seasonal Influenza Vaccine - High Risk Pilgrims
- 3) COVID-19 vaccination-
 - Both dose Vaccination certificate OR
 - Lab-confirmed disease-free report (Disease free certification in Pilgrims Healthcard)
- 4) Oral Polio Vaccine- recommended



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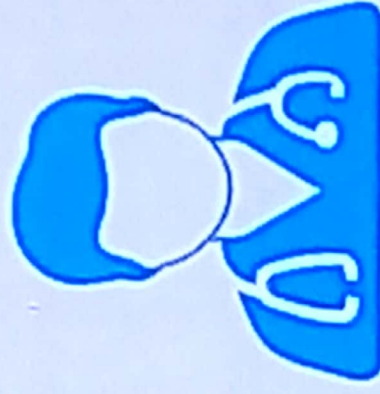
5.1 Pre-departure Phase (India)

3. Medical Deputation for Haj Pilgrimage

- **Online Haj Deputation portal (NIC)** is used for medical deputation process since 2025.
- Medical Haj deputation screening and selection committee in place
- Total medical deputationists selected for Haj 2026: **369**
 - Doctors: 168
 - Nurses: 96
 - Paramedics: 103
 - Medical Coordinators: 2

• **Selection Criteria-**

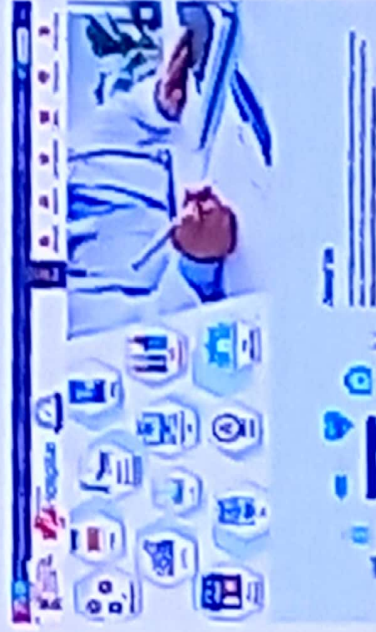
- Age criteria
- 30:70 experienced vs first-timers
- Gender balance
- Specialty optimisation
- Balanced State/UT representation



5.1 Pre-departure Phase (India)

4. Training program for Medical Deputationist

- Handling Medical Emergencies (heatstroke, dehydration, cardiac issues, respiratory infections, orthopaedic, etc)
- Infection prevention control and Biomedical waste management
- Infectious Disease Surveillance & Outbreak Control – majorly respiratory and food borne
- Hands on training on **NEXTGEN(e-hospital module) portal (NIC)** to be used in KSA



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[Link- nextgen.hospital.gov.in/dashboard/](http://Link-nextgen.hospital.gov.in/dashboard/)

5.1 Pre-departure Phase (India)

5. Role of SHIs in Medical Screening and Vaccination

- Ensure screening is **clinical**, not ceremonial - ensure **strict adherence to MoHFW SOPs** for medical examination and fitness certification
- Watch for:
 - Incomplete history
 - Undisclosed chronic illness
 - **Identify vulnerable pilgrims** (elderly, co-morbid, pregnant, persons with disabilities)
 - External pressure for clearance
- Escalate concerns early.



5.2 During Haj- Medical Care services delivery in KSA

1. Medical centers established at key locations in 2025:

- Mecca
- Madina
- **Mina**
- **Arafat**
- Muzdalifah

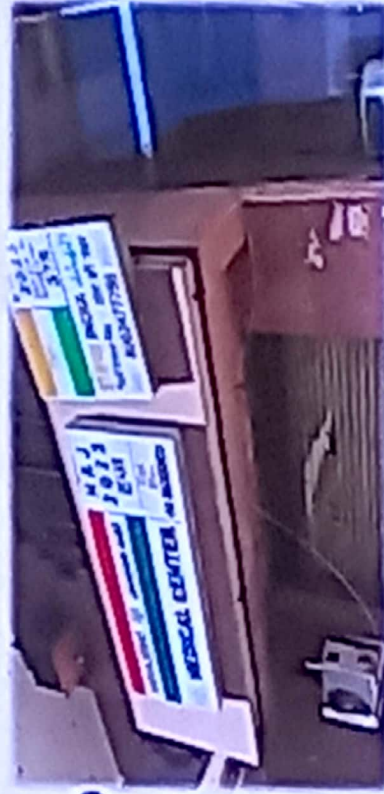
**Medical care in core Haj Area
Mina & Arafat (2025)**

- 31 dispensaries established
- 17,600 pilgrims treated in core 5 days
- Dedicated emergency teams
- Significant reduction in mortality

2. Medical Care data of previous Haj season 2025

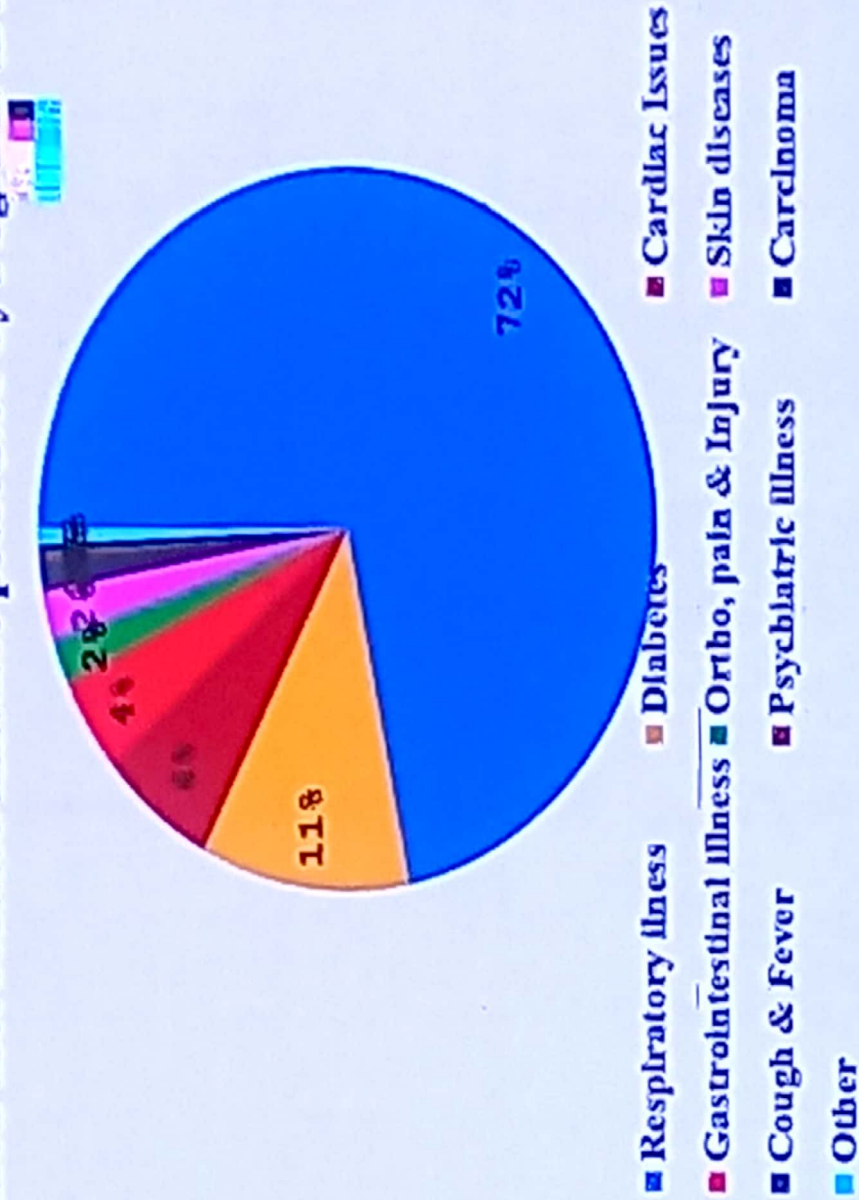
- Over 2.5 lakh OPD consultations and 1,201 IPD admissions

- **Mortality reduced to 69** (from 201 in 2024)



5.2 During Haj- Medical Care services delivery in KSA

2.1 Most common morbidities/illnesses presented by Pilgrims in Haj 2025



5.2 During Haj- Medical Care services delivery in KSA

2.2 Pilgrims Instructions on disease prevention

Chronic Illness

- Do not skip medicines
- Carry glucometer / BP monitor
- Asthma: inhaler / nebulizer

Infection Prevention

- Wear mask in crowds
- Wash hands frequently
- Avoid sick persons

Medical Help

- Indian/empanelled hospitals
- Treatment is **FREE** of Cost

Food Safety

- Eat fresh, washed food
- Avoid raw milk / undercooked meat
- No food kept > 2 hrs

Hydration & Heat

- Drink water / ORS
- Avoid direct sun
- Wash face often

5.3 Emergency response & referral management in KSA

1. The Ambulance Services in KSA for Indian Haj Pilgrims:

- 24/7 medical transportation at key locations- Makkah, Madinah, Jeddah and Masher region.
- Strategically stationed fleet, continuous command oversight, prompt response, safe transfers, and sustained care for Pilgrims
- Total – 20 Basic Life Support ambulances were deployed in 2025

2. Scope of Ambulance Services

- Casualty Transfers: Round-trip medical support is provided as needed.
- Core-Haj Coverage: Ambulance availability extends to Mina and Arafat regions during the core Haj period wherever permitted.

3. Referral facilities

- Referral to identified Medical Service Providers/empaneled hospitals in KSA

Role of SILLs in emergency & referrals

- Assist pilgrims in accessing medical facilities and emergency services
- Monitor issues related to medical care delivery, crowd movement and safety, especially during core Haj days

6. What SHIs Should Remember

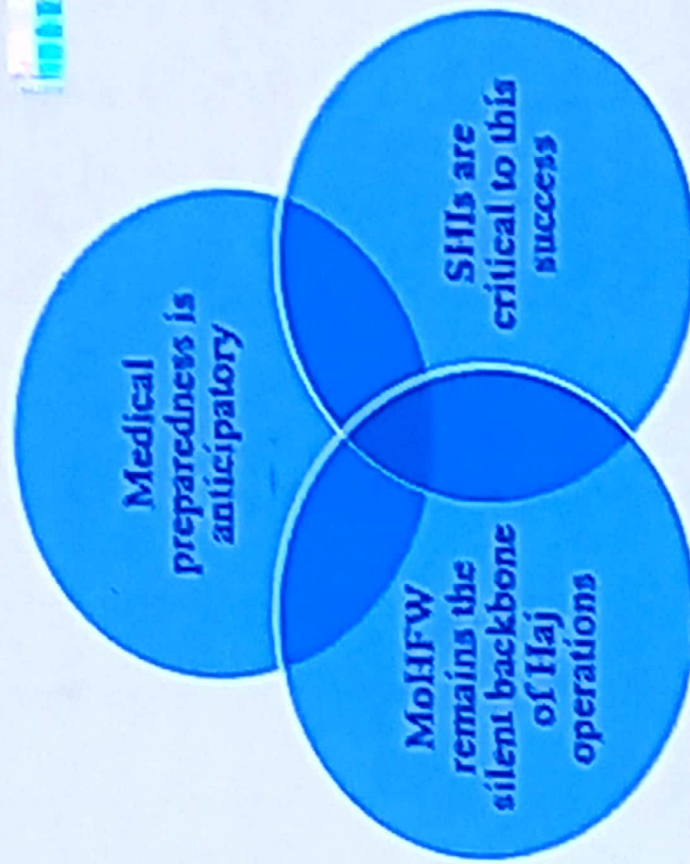


1. Integrity of medical screening in India
2. Protection of vulnerable pilgrims
3. Escalation of risks in India and KSA

'Your vigilance saves lives before crises emerge'



7. Closing Message



*'A successful Haj is not just measured by rituals completed,
but by the precious lives protected'*